Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 6
♥ A Q J 9 8
♦ A K 8 5
♣ K Q J

♠ Q J 9 8 3
♥ 10 4
♦ Q J 10 9
♣ 6 4

♠ K 7 5 4
♥ 6 3
♦ 6 2
♣ 10 8 5 3 2

♠ A 10 2
♥ K 7 5 2
♦ 7 4 3
♣ A 9 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦6

You dealt this hand.

This is a big hand. But not quite enough to open 2♣. So you open 1♥ and partner responds 3♥. Now what?

You might bid 4♦ as a slam try, but it is probably just as well to go ahead and ask for Aces. So you bid 4NT and partner owns up to holding 2 Aces. What is your next bid?

You have all the Aces but don't go crazy. Partner only has 11-12 points so don't think too Grand! Bid 6♥.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 7
♥ 10 8 6
♦ A Q 8 5
♣ 6 3 2

♠ J 10 6 3 2
♥ 9 3
♦ 10 4 2
♣ Q J 4

♠ A Q 4
♥ J 4 2
♦ J 9 7
♣ K 9 7 5

♠ K 5
♥ A K Q 7 5
♦ K 6 3
♣ A 10 8

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣Q

The bidding has been as shown.

With 6 points you must respond and you should let partner know you have support for his suit. So you bid 2♥ and he promptly raises to 4♥. It's a good thing he had 20 points isn't it.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ K 10 7 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 3

♠ K Q J 10 9
♥ A
♦ 9 7 3
♣ Q J 5 2

♠ A 6 5 3
♥ J 6
♦ 10 6 2
♣ A 10 9 7

♠ 8
♥ Q 9 8 5 3
♦ K J 8 5
♣ 8 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦2

The bidding has been as shown.

When you have a weak, distributional hand with 5 of partner's suit an immediate jump to game is usually the best approach. If he has a good hand you will probably make the contract. If he is minimum then you might get a preemptive effect and stop your LHO from entering the bidding.

This is a good example. Partner may be lucky and make 4♥. But if they had had an opportunity to compete the opponents might well be able to make 4♠.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A K 9 7 2 ♥ Q 5 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ 10 6 5	
♠ Q 8 5 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 10 8 6 ♣ K J 8 2		♠ J 10 6 ♥ 10 9 2 ♦ K 9 5 ♣ A Q 9 4
	♠ 3 ♥ A K J 8 7 3 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♥4

The bidding has been as shown.

You can't support partner's ♥s with only 2 of them so you bid your nice ♠ suit. Partner then jumps to 3♥. Now

Here's where a lot of players go wrong. Since they only promised 4 ♠s with their first response they think they should now rebid them to show partner they had 5. And this **MIGHT** work if it turns out partner has 3 ♠s. Not only is this a risky bid, it is unnecessary. When partner jump rebid ♥s he showed 16-18 points and 6 ♥s. So you know of an 8-card fit and you know you should be in game. Bid 4♥.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A Q 10 9 3 ♥ A 9 2 ♦ K Q J 3 ♣ 4	
♠ 8 4 ♥ K 7 4 3 ♦ A 10 8 5 ♣ 10 7 2		♠ 6 5 ♥ Q J 10 6 ♦ 9 6 ♣ J 9 8 6 3
	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ 8 5 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ A K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

The bidding has been as shown.

As soon as partner opens 1♠ you know you will settle for nothing less than the ♠ game. The problem with bidding 4♠ right now is that partner will take you for the "weak-distributional-with-five-trumps" hand. So you temporize by first bidding 2♣. Partner rebids 2♦.

You now jump to 4♠, completing the picture of an opening hand with good ♠ support. Partner bids 4NT. What say you?

This is Blackwood so you answer 5♦ for one Ace. Partner says 6♠.